Oghatharana Mārgaya 01

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

By Venerable Kolombagama Dhammadeepa Thero

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The Path of Crossing the Torrent

A Gift of Dhamma,
dedicated to the faithful ones
who strive for liberation
from the suffering of Saṃsāra

By Venerable Kolombugama Dhammadeepa Thero

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Sharing of Merit

May the power of merit generated by this gift of Dhamma be a causing resource for the realization of the Supreme Peace of Nibbana for our honorable teacher, Most Venerable Asgiriwalpola Sudassi Maha Thero, who guided and advised us from the very beginning to prepare this book;

for all the kalyanamitta venerables and devotees who assisted in various ways!

Oghatharaṇa Mārgaya

The Path to Crossing the Torrent

To realize the Four Noble Truths,

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The Noble Eightfold Path must be reached

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The Seven Factors of Enlightenment must be developed

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The Five Spiritual Powers must be developed

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The Five Spiritual Faculties must be developed

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The Four Bases of Spiritual Power must be developed

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The Fourfold Right Efforts must be developed

↓↑

The Four Foundations of Mindfulness must be developed

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The necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara must be arisen

↓↑

The fear regarding Samsara must be arisen

↓↑

The phenomena of birth, old-age, sickness and death must be investigated

↓↑

Mundane Right View must be present

↓↑

Unwholesome signs and wholesome signs must be identified

↓↑

Unwholesome roots and wholesome roots must be identified

↓↑

Unwholesomeness and wholesomeness must be identified

↓↑

The True Dhamma must be listened

↓↑

Good Spiritual friends must be met

↓↑

Prior merit must be present

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- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon no. 01
- An Introduction to the Series of Sermons

Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa!
Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa!
Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

Starting today, you can listen in this manner

The faithful, wise and compassionate Buddhist devotees, who listen to the Dhamma through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube Channel. We were invited by these meritorious ones, invited us to prepare the opportunity to listen to those Dhamma sermons that we conducted on Poya days and meditation programs through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel. So, we also had a genuine need: to provide the opportunity to listen to those Dhamma sermons conducted in Poya programs and meditation programs through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel. However, it took us a little while to achieve this because we did not have the necessary resources. Having now found those resources, starting today, you can listen in this way to that continuous series of programs conducted in meditation programs and Poya day programs through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel.

So, the sermon we are giving today an introduction to the series of sermons is what these meritorious ones are preparing to listen to. So, we hope that within today we can briefly introduce the Oghatharana organization, the Oghatharana forest monastery, and also about this Dhamma sermon series.

What the Oghatharana Organization is

First, we hope to make you aware of the Oghatharana organization. We began the Oghatharana organization in the year 2017. From 2017 until now, through the Oghatharana organization, we have operated as an organization providing various Dhamma sermons, various meritorious deeds, and also providing the necessary background for these meritorious ones to fulfill qualities, accumulate merits, and gather wholesome deeds such as dāna (donation), sīla (morality), bhāvanā (meditation). Meritorious ones, the main aim with which we undertook to start this Oghatharana organization is to support, to the best of our ability, those noble ones striving for liberation from the suffering of saṃsāra. With that as the goal, this organized group is moving forward day by day, fulfilling its objectives one by one. This is yet another forward step taken by our organization for that purpose: to provide the necessary environment for these meritorious ones who listen to Dhamma through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel. So, meritorious ones, the Oghatharana organization began in 2017 with the aim of providing the necessary guidance for those noble ones striving for liberation from the suffering of saṃsāra. That is our primary objective.

The next step that we have taken as the Oghatharana Organization

So, until now, through the Oghatharana organization, Poya day programs and various meditation programs at temples and monastic sites have been conducted for these meritorious ones. Also, a large number of Dhamma books have been provided into the hands of these meritorious ones. These meritorious ones have been able to gain pure Dhamma knowledge by reading those books. Also, through the Oghatharana organization, an annual great stūpa pilgrimage is being conducted for these meritorious ones, with the help and assistance of all meritorious ones who help us, both in Sri Lanka and abroad. Furthermore, through the Oghatharana organization, action is also being taken to provide the various fourfold requisites necessary for many difficult and remote forest monasteries. Also, meritorious ones, through the Oghatharana organization, we are currently engaged in providing Dhamma books and other necessary stationery to the venerable monks who receive pirivena education. Also, constructing and repairing necessary kutis (dwellings) and senāsanās (lodgings) for venerable monks residing in seclusion, and such work is being done.

So, through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel, from the Oghatharana organization, we hoped to present a program series like this to these meritorious ones in the three languages: Sinhala, English, and also Tamil. Now you can listen to that sermon series in this manner. So, that is the forward step we have taken as the Oghatharana organization in this year 2026. So, we believe that by now these meritorious ones have gained some awareness about the Oghatharana organization.

What the Oghatharana Forest monastery is

Next, we hope to make you aware of the Oghatharana forest monastery. It is while residing here at the Oghatharana Forest Monastery that we, through the Oghatharana Organization, begin the recording of this series of Dhamma sermons. So, we wish to say something about this Oghatharana forest monastery as well.
The land for constructing this Oghatharana forest monastery was offered to us by Mr. Kirthi from Gampaha. After that gentleman offered us this place, we very quickly prepared and arranged the necessary kutis and senāsanās and rock caves for the venerable monks, and have now completed the construction of the Oghatharana forest monastery within a period close to three years. Now, several venerable monks reside at the Oghatharana forest monastery. So, because of the commencement of this Oghatharana forest monastery in this way, we are able to bring such a program series to you from the Oghatharana forest monastery through the Oghatharana organization. So, we believe that in this way you have gained some awareness about the Oghatharana forest monastery.

What the 'Oghatharana Margaya'(The Path of Crossing the Torrent) is

So, while taking an entry point to this program series, we have described the Oghatharana organization and the Oghatharana forest monastery. Now we are ready to present a name for this program series. Today we present to these meritorious ones the name for this program series as 'Oghatharana Margaya' (The Path

of Crossing the Torrent). In the future, we will present this sermon series to you under the name Oghatharana Margaya, with sermon number one, sermon number two, etc., with topics.
So, what actually is this 'ogha'? There is a reason for naming this 'Oghatharana organization', 'the Oghatharana forest monastery', and also naming this program series as 'Oghatharana Margaya'. To understand that, one must know the meaning of the word 'ogha'. What is 'ogha'? What does it mean to cross the ogha? These meritorious ones should know this matter. Then they can understand why we undertook to name this program series, this sermon series, as 'Oghatharana Margaya'.
So, actually, this 'ogha' refers to a torrent. 'Ogha' is a name for a forceful, rushing current. These meritorious ones can see that a torrent is a current of water rushing down from above with great speed. Now in a river, that current of water flows downwards rapidly. If something gets caught in that stream of water, it is carried away in the direction the water flows. Similarly, meritorious ones, because these forces repeatedly sweep us back into the great ocean of Samsara, the Buddha describes four such torrents in the Dhamma: kāma-ogha (the torrent of sensual desire), bhava-ogha (the torrent of existence), diṭṭhi-ogha (the torrent of views), and avijja-ogha (the torrent of ignorance).

<u>To get beyond this saṃsāra</u>

Due to getting caught in this kāma-ogha, this torrent of sensual craving (kāmataṇhā), we are born again and again in saṃsāra. We join saṃsāra.

Due to getting caught in this bhava-ogha, this torrent of craving for existence (bhavataṇhā), we are born again and again in saṃsāra. We join saṃsāra.
Due to getting caught in this diṭṭhi-ogha, this torrent of craving for views, we are born again and again in saṃsāra. We join saṃsāra.
Due to getting caught in this avijja-ogha, this torrent of ignorance, we are born again and again in saṃsāra. We join saṃsāra.
So, it is in this way that this existence in saṃsāra occurs. It is in this way that saṃsāra is formed. So, meritorious ones, if someone wants to get beyond this saṃsāra, they must cross this torrent of sensual craving (kāmataṇhā). If someone wants to get beyond this saṃsāra, they must cross this torrent of craving for existence (bhavataṇhā). If someone wants to get beyond this saṃsāra, they must cross this torrent of craving for views. If someone wants to get beyond this saṃsāra, they must cross this torrent of ignorance. So, if someone does not get caught in these four torrents, they cross saṃsāra. They cross over saṃsāra.

Meritorious ones, to stop getting caught in this torrent of sensuality (kāma), getting caught in this torrent of craving for existence (bhavataṇhā), getting caught in this torrent of craving for views, getting caught in this torrent of ignorance, one must listen well to the noble Dhamma (saddhamma) taught to the world by the Fortunate Buddha. One must properly bear in mind that Dhamma that is listened to. And having properly borne that noble Dhamma in mind, one must act in accordance with it. One must conduct oneself accordingly.

Meritorious ones, to get beyond getting caught in this torrent of sensuality, getting caught in this torrent of craving for existence, getting caught in this torrent of craving for views, getting caught in this torrent of ignorance, one must listen well to the noble Dhamma taught to the world by the Fortunate Buddha. One must properly bear in mind that Dhamma that is listened to. And having properly borne that noble Dhamma in mind, one must act in accordance with it. One must conduct oneself accordingly.

Then, without getting caught in that torrent of sensual craving, you can proceed. Then, without getting caught in that torrent of craving for existence, you can proceed. Then, without getting caught in that torrent of craving for views, you can proceed. Then, without getting caught in that torrent of ignorance, you can proceed.
That is, meritorious ones, when craving for sensual pleasures (kāmataṇhā) is abandoned from this mindstream, when craving for existence (bhavataṇhā) is abandoned from this mindstream, when craving for views is abandoned from this mindstream, that is, meritorious ones, when ignorance is abandoned from this mindstream, saṃsāra does not lengthen again. The saṃsāra ends. One crosses the saṃsāra.

<u>The process of crossing this Samsara without getting caught in this saṃsāra</u>

To these meritorious ones, we said a torrent is a current of water flowing rapidly downwards. So, crossing this torrent means the act of going upstream, against that current. So, meritorious ones, the entire noble Dhamma of the Fortunate Buddha, the whole teaching,

contains the process of not getting caught in this saṃsāra, of crossing this saṃsāra. For that purpose, the practices that the Fortunate Buddha has introduced for these meritorious ones are the fulfillment of qualities called dāna, sīla, bhāvanā. For that purpose, the practices that the Fortunate Buddha has introduced for these meritorious ones are the fulfillment of qualities called sīla (morality), samādhi (stillness), paññā (wisdom).
So, if someone becomes a person who fulfills the qualities of dāna, sīla, bhāvanā, sīla, samādhi, paññā, then that person is one who crosses saṃsāra. That person becomes one who crosses the torrent (ogha).
Therefore, to cross this torrent, you must listen well to this Dhamma of the Fortunate Buddha. Bear it well in mind. Conduct yourself well in accordance with it. So then, to conduct oneself thus, these meritorious ones must listen to the noble Dhamma (saddhamma) of the Fortunate Buddha. So, to the best of our ability, we hope to present to these meritorious ones from today onwards the noble Dhamma preached by the Fortunate Buddha as a sermon series under the name 'Oghatharana Margaya'.

The resource donors who helped us

To these meritorious ones, we present one more small matter here. We were able to accomplish such a meritorious act of Dhamma-dāna because of the help and assistance received from resource donors. So, at this moment, I also wish to mention and recollect the names of those donor contributors and share the merit.

Meritorious ones, so, for us to obtain these resources, **the main contributors were: Ms. Sureni Anurangika from Dangalla (for**

Camera) and Mr. Tusitha from Kotte (for Computer). Also, Mr. Ajith Ranasinghe. Also, further contributing for that purpose are: Mrs. Vajira Abeykoon. Also, Mrs. Guruge. Also, Mr. Eranga. Also, Mr. Saman from Aturugiriya, as well as my sister, Saman Aiya and my father. Also, Mr. Kasun Chamod. Also, the membership fees provided by the members of the Oghatharana organization were used by us to obtain these resources.

Also, when purchasing these equipments, our Mr. Charles de Silva, who does these video works, helped us and assisted us. He provided all the technical assistance in purchasing these. Also, Mr. Nadeera helped and assisted us in this. Also, our Mr. Janith helps and assists us in this. Also, we recollect the meritorious ones who have supported with offering alms, and the four requisites from the days this forest monastery was being built until now.
We recollect everyone who helped and assisted in building this Oghatharana forest monastery. Also, we recollect the meritorious devotees and venerable monks who helped and assisted us during times when we were in remote and distant kutis and senāsanās. Also, we recollect those venerable elder monks who gifted us to this sāsana (dispensation of the lord buddha), our revered teacher and preceptors, headed by the great Sangha jewel. Also, we recollect the Venerable Uditabodhi Thero residing in the forest monastery.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

So, to all these meritorious ones, we invite, remind, and recollect: connect with this Dhamma sermon series called 'Oghatharana

Margaya' and listen to this Dhamma. Reflect wisely and properly on this Dhamma. Take whatever should be taken from this into your life, and conduct yourself accordingly within the Dhamma. When conducting yourself thus, indeed, the path will open for you to cross saṃsāra, to end saṃsāra, to become free from suffering. So, may the necessary strength, courage, fortune, opportunity, and pathway be provided to all these meritorious ones through the blessings of the sublime Triple Gem! With that aspiration, we conclude this introductory sermon.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 02
- The Sequence of the Sermon Series

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Exalted One, the Supremely Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

Indeed, today is the second sermon of this series

Dear kind, compassionate Buddhist devotees endowed with faith and wisdom, who listen to the Dhamma through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel:

You are preparing today to join us for yet another Dhamma sermon. In our previous sermon, we shared an introduction regarding this sermon series. We mentioned that we are naming this series "The Path of Crossing the Torrent" (Oghatharana Margaya). Today, we are conducting the second sermon of that series in this manner through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel.

Accordingly, in today's sermon, we intend to present the sequence of the sermon series conducted under the name "The Path of Crossing the Torrent" in the form of topics; to mention under which topics you will be given the opportunity to listen to these Dhamma sermons in the future.

To realize the Four Noble Truths, one must enter the Noble Eightfold Path

As an opening in our first sermon, we stated that through this sermon series, we hope to present to you the practical program that must be followed in order to cross the wilderness of Samsara and to be liberated from suffering. Therefore, dear devotees, if we are to cross this wilderness of Samsara, we all must realize the Four Noble Truths. If someone is to realize these Four Noble Truths, they must enter the Noble Eightfold Path.

Devotees, the Fortunate One mentions this to us in the Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta, the discourse where He set the Wheel of Dhamma in motion at the Deer Park in Isipatana, addressing the five ascetics, in this manner:

"Dve me, bhikkhave, antā pabbajitena na sevitabbā. Yo cāyaṃ kāmesu kāmasukhallikānuyogo hīno gammo pothujjaniko anariyo anatthasaṃhito, yo cāyaṃ attakilamathānuyogo dukkho anariyo anatthasaṃhito. Ete te, bhikkhave, ubho ante anupagamma majjhimā paṭipadā tathāgatena abhisambuddhā cakkhukaraṇī ñāṇakaraṇī upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati. Katamā ca sā, bhikkhave, majjhimā paṭipadā tathāgatena abhisambuddhā cakkhukaraṇī ñāṇakaraṇī upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati: ayameva ariyo aṭṭhaṅgiko maggo."

"Monks, these two extremes ought not to be cultivated by one who has gone forth. What two? There is the devotion to the indulgence of sense-pleasures in sensual objects—which is low, vulgar, the way of ordinary people, ignoble, and unbeneficial; and there is the devotion to self-mortification—which is painful, ignoble, and unbeneficial. Monks, without veering towards either of these two extremes, the Tathagata has awakened to the Middle Way, which

gives rise to vision, gives rise to knowledge, and leads to peace, to direct knowledge, to full enlightenment, to Nibbana. And what, monks, is that Middle Way awakened to by the Tathagata, which gives rise to vision, gives rise to knowledge, and leads to peace, to direct knowledge, to full enlightenment, to Nibbana? It is this very Noble Eightfold Path."

If one has entered the Noble Eightfold Path, he sees the Four Noble Truths and Dependent Origination

It is preached that by abandoning these two extremes—namely **Kamasukhallikanuyoga** (indulgence in sensual pleasures) and **Attakilamathanuyoga** (self-mortification)—and by entering the Noble Eightfold Path, the Fortunate Buddha attained Supreme Enlightenment. Devotees, in that discourse, where it is preached that the Fortunate One attained Supreme Enlightenment by abandoning those two extremes and entering the Noble Eightfold Path, the discourse begins by preaching about the Noble Eightfold Path. However, devotees, although the Fortunate One begins the discourse regarding the Noble Eightfold Path in that manner, what He preaches thereafter are the Four Noble Truths.

Devotees, the reason for that is: if someone has entered this Noble Eightfold Path, what he sees are the Four Noble Truths and Dependent Origination (Paticca Samuppada). That is why the Noble Eightfold Path is preached at the beginning, and the Four Noble Truths are preached thereafter.

One must first know the place where one has to arrive

Therefore, devotees, you, I, and everyone else—including all the gods and Brahmas in this world—must enter the Noble Eightfold Path to see the Four Noble Truths. When we enter the Noble Eightfold Path, what we get to see are the Four Noble Truths and

Dependent Origination. Then, devotees, what must we do to cross over from this Samsara? We must see the Four Noble Truths. We must realize the Four Noble Truths. Therefore, to see the Four Noble Truths, we have to enter the Noble Eightfold Path. Devotees, then, one realizes the Four Noble Truths and sees the Four Noble Truths through entering the Noble Eightfold Path. Thus, you, I, and everyone in this world including gods and Brahmas, have to enter the Noble Eightfold Path to be liberated from suffering. So, it is towards the Noble Eightfold Path that we have to come. We must first know the place where we have to arrive. The place we have to arrive at is the Noble Eightfold Path.

The Noble Eightfold Path is born by making the Seven Factors of Enlightenment a condition

Devotees, then, it is through entering this Noble Eightfold Path that one sees the Four Noble Truths. To see the Four Noble Truths, it is necessary to enter the Noble Eightfold Path. Devotees, this Noble Eightfold Path is not something that exists on its own. It is something that is born due to causes and conditions.

Devotees, for this Noble Eightfold Path to be born, the Seven Factors of Enlightenment (Satta Bojjhanga) become the condition. Therefore, devotees, if we are to enter the Noble Eightfold Path, we must cultivate the Seven Factors of Enlightenment. Devotees, it is dependent on the Seven Factors of Enlightenment that the Noble Eightfold Path is born.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for these Seven Factors of Enlightenment to be born. The cause for the Seven Factors of Enlightenment to be born—the condition—is the Five Spiritual Powers (Pancha Bala). It is by having the Five Spiritual Powers as the cause and the condition that the Seven Factors of Enlightenment are born.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for these Five Spiritual Powers to be born. The cause for the Five Spiritual Powers to be born—the condition—is the Five Spiritual Faculties (Pancha Indriya). It is by having the Five Spiritual Faculties as the cause and the condition that the Five Spiritual Powers are born.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for these Five Spiritual Faculties to be born. The cause for the Five Spiritual Faculties to be born—the condition—is the Four Bases of Spiritual Power (Sathara Iddhipada). It is by having the Four Bases of Spiritual Power as the cause and the condition that the Five Spiritual Faculties are born.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for these Bases of Spiritual Power to be born. The cause for the Four Bases of Spiritual Power to be born—the condition—is the Four Right Efforts (Sathara Sammappadhana). It is by having the Four Right Efforts as the cause and the condition that the Bases of Spiritual Power are born.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for these Four Right Efforts to be born. The cause for the Four Right Efforts to be born—the condition—is the Four Foundations of Mindfulness (Sathara Satipatthana). It is by having the Four Foundations of Mindfulness as the cause and the condition that the Four Right Efforts are born.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition to cultivate these Four Foundations of Mindfulness. The cause to cultivate the Four Foundations of Mindfulness—the condition—is the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara. It is by having the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara as the

cause and the condition that one cultivates the Four Foundations of Mindfulness.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara to arise. The cause for the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara to arise—the condition—is the arising of fear regarding Samsara. It is by having the fear regarding Samsara as the cause and the condition that the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara arises.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for the fear regarding Samsara to arise. The cause for the fear regarding Samsara to arise—the condition—is the investigation into the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death. It is by having the investigation into the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death as the cause and the condition that fear regarding Samsara arises.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for the investigation into the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death. The cause for the investigation into the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death—the condition—is the arising of Mundane Right View (Laukika Samma Ditthi). It is by having the arising of Mundane Right View as the cause and the condition that one investigates the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for the arising of Mundane Right View. The cause for the arising of Mundane Right View—the condition—is identifying unwholesome signs (Akusala Nimithi) and identifying wholesome signs (Kusala Nimithi). It is by having the identification of unwholesome signs and wholesome signs as the cause and the condition that Mundane Right View arises.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for identifying unwholesome signs and identifying wholesome signs. The cause for identifying unwholesome signs and identifying wholesome signs—the condition—is identifying the unwholesome roots (Akusala Mula) and identifying the wholesome roots (Kusala Mula). It is by having the identification of unwholesome roots and wholesome roots as the cause and the condition that the identification of unwholesome signs and wholesome signs occurs.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for identifying unwholesome roots and identifying wholesome roots. The cause for identifying unwholesome roots and identifying wholesome roots—the condition—is identifying the unwholesomeness (Akusala) and identifying the wholesomeness (Kusala). It is by having the identification of the unwholesomeness and identifying the wholesomeness as the cause and the condition that the identification of unwholesome roots and wholesome roots occurs.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for identifying the unwholesomeness and identifying the wholesomeness. The cause for identifying the unwholesomeness and identifying the wholesomeness—the condition—is listening to the True Dhamma (Saddhamma Sravanaya). It is by having the listening to the True Dhamma as the cause and the condition that the identification of the unwholesomeness and identifying the wholesomeness occurs.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for listening to the True Dhamma. The cause for listening to the True Dhamma—the condition—is associating with good spiritual friends (Kalyana-mitra Sevanaya). It is by having the association with good spiritual friends as the cause and the condition that the listening to the True Dhamma occurs.

Devotees, then, there is also a cause and a condition for associating with noble friends. The cause for the association with good spiritual friends—the condition—is the possession of past merits (Pera Pin). It is by having the possession of past merits as the cause and the condition that the association with good spiritual friends occurs.

So:

By making the possession of past merits the condition, one associates with good spiritual friends.

By making the association with good spiritual friends the condition, one listens to the True Dhamma.

By making the listening to the True Dhamma the condition, one identifies the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness.

By making the identification of the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness the condition, one identifies the unwholesome roots and the wholesome roots.

By making the identification of the unwholesome roots and the wholesome roots the condition, one identifies the unwholesome signs and the wholesome signs.

By making the identification of the unwholesome signs and the wholesome signs the condition, Mundane Right View arises.

By making the arising of Mundane Right View the condition, the mind leans towards repeatedly thinking and reflecting on the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death.

By making the leaning of the mind towards repeatedly thinking and reflecting on the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death the condition, fear regarding Samsara arises.

By making the arising of fear regarding Samsara the condition, the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara arises.

By making the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara the condition, one cultivates the Four Foundations of Mindfulness.

By making the cultivation of the Four Foundations of Mindfulness the condition, the Four Right Efforts arise.

By making the Four Right Efforts the condition, the Four Bases of Spiritual Power begin to develop.

By making the Four Bases of Spiritual Power the condition, the Five Spiritual Faculties begin to develop.

By making the Five Spiritual Faculties the condition, the Five Spiritual Powers begin to develop.

By making the Five Spiritual Powers the condition, the Seven Factors of Enlightenment begin to develop.

By making the Seven Factors of Enlightenment the condition, the Noble Eightfold Path is born.

In this way, one enters the Noble Eightfold Path. Through entering the Noble Eightfold Path, one sees the Four Noble Truths and Dependent Origination.

In that way, devotees, when one sees the Four Noble Truths, when one sees Dependent Origination, one has arrived at the point where the journey of Samsara and existence ends. One sees how to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara. That matter of being liberated from the suffering of Samsara is thus seen within oneself by being established in the Dhamma.

Therefore, devotees, now the path to be traveled, the way of the journey to enter the Noble Eightfold Path, must be clear to these devotees. We hope to teach you the Dhamma to the best of our ability under these topics, naming it "The Path of Crossing the Torrent".

Those topics are:

- The possession of past merits.
- Association with good spiritual friends.
- Listening to the True Dhamma.
- Identifying the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness.
- Identifying the unwholesome roots and the wholesome roots.
- Identifying the unwholesome signs and the wholesome signs.
- Identifying Mundane Right View.
- Investigating the phenomena of birth, aging, sickness, and death.
- The arising of fear regarding Samsara.
- The arising of the necessity to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara.
- Cultivating the Four Foundations of Mindfulness.
- Cultivating the Four Right Efforts.
- Cultivating the Four Bases of Spiritual Power.
- Cultivating the Five Spiritual Faculties.
- Cultivating the Five Spiritual Powers.
- Cultivating the Seven Factors of Enlightenment.
- Entering the Noble Eightfold Path.

- The Four Noble Truths.
- Dependent Origination.

The Dhamma must be well-retained within the mind

Through these twenty topics, we hope to present to you in sequence the Dhamma sermon series we have started as "The Path of Crossing the Torrent" in the future. In that, devotees, you must be skillful; we will teach you in proper order, from the very beginning up to the point of realizing the Four Noble Truths, topic by topic, how to identify the unwholesomeness and abandon it, and how to identify the wholesomeness and develop it within this Buddha Sasana (Dispensation of the Lord Buddha). In that, these devotees must listen to the Dhamma well. The Dhamma that has been heard must be well-retained within the mind. One must strive to see that Dhamma within oneself while behaving according to the Dhamma that has been retained. It is when one sees this Dhamma within oneself that the journey towards that Noble Eightfold Path begins for us through the Dhamma. Likewise, the work of this life to see the Four Noble Truths is commenced.

Mindfulness, Stillness, and Wisdom arise within our mindstream

When you practice the Dhamma, you will be able to see the nature within this Dhamma that leads you forward and forward. What is meant by leading forward and forward is, let's say we have identified the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness; by making that identification the condition, there is a nature within this Dhamma that leads one to identify the next state of Dhamma. That is the Opanayika (leading onwards) quality of this Dhamma. That happens when we practice the Dhamma; Mindfulness (Sati), Stillness (Samadhi), and Wisdom (Panna) arise within our mindstream. As those arising states of Mindfulness, Stillness, and Wisdom develop and develop, this going forward and forward in the Dhamma—this

leading forward and forward—occurs. Therefore, when these devout people listen to the Dhamma and investigate that Dhamma well with wisdom, they will be able to see those states of Dhamma within themselves. When one sees those states of Dhamma in that way, the journey towards the Noble Eightfold Path begins to start.

Therefore, may the Triple Gem bless all these devotees!

So, for that reason, we say again today, this is an act performed for your liberation from the suffering of Samsara to the best of our ability. Through this listening to the Dhamma, may that process of yours to be liberated from the suffering of Samsara become clear! May that way of the journey become uncluttered! I aspire that this merit of listening to the Dhamma becomes a supportive cause for these devotees to travel towards the Noble Eightfold Path very quickly and without delay! We conclude the Dhamma sermon that was conducted while explaining the sequence of the program series in this way.

Next, in the third sermon, we hope to explain to you regarding the possession of past merits.

So then, may the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 03
- The Possession Past Merits (Part 01)

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Exalted One, the Supremely Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

<u>So today, this is the third sermon in this series</u>

Compassionate Buddhist devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who listen to the Dhamma through the 'Oghatarana Daham Sangrahaya' YouTube channel:

Today, you are preparing to join us for yet another Dhamma sermon. In our previous sermon, we provided an introduction to the sequence of this sermon series. Today, we conduct the third sermon within this series called "The Path of Crossing the Torrent." In the first sermon, we gave an introduction to the series. In the second sermon, we mentioned the sequence of future discourses, the outline, and the specific topics. Today, in this third sermon, we intend to begin with the very first topic of that sequence: "The Possession of Past Merits".

May this Dhamma sermon be a cause and a fortune for all of you, and for all beings in the world, including gods and Brahmas, to realize the Dhamma! With that aspiration, we begin this discourse.

The Possession of Past Merits

As mentioned earlier, in the first sermon we introduced this series, and in the second sermon we outlined the sequence of topics. Today, as the first topic of this series, we begin the third sermon focusing on the matter of having past merits. The journey toward realizing the Four Noble Truths begins—and must begin—by understanding this point. We must move forward based on the foundation of this fact: "The Possession of Past Merits."

Forgetting the Reason for Coming to this Human World

Devotees, throughout this long 'Samsara', we have performed many meritorious deeds such as giving (Dana), virtue (Sila), and meditation (Bhavana) within previous Buddha Sasana, aspiring for Nibbana. In Samsara, both within those Buddha Sasana and outside of them, when we performed merits, what did we aspire for?

Whether you offered flowers, attended to the Buddha, served the Sangha, cared for your parents, or even gave a little food to an animal—even when giving that bit of food—what did you aspire for?

"May this noble meritorious deed be a cause and a fortune for me to escape this cruel, harsh, and terrifying Samsara, to realize the Four Noble Truths, and to find peace in the Great Immortal Nibbana!" This was the wish and the aspiration.

Therefore, in past lives as well as in this life, what have you aspired for by performing merits and wholesome deeds? Nibbana. You wished to realize the Four Noble Truths. You wished: "May this merit be a cause to realize the Four Noble Truths!"

Then, we must understand that when coming from the past life to this life, what helped and supported us was the merit we gathered

with the intent: "I must see Nibbana." It was the wholesome deed gathered for Nibbana. If so, why have we come to this human world? It is to see Nibbana. This is the very reason that helped us arrive here. If someone asks, "Why did you come to the human world?" the answer is, "To attain Nibbana."

However, devotees, today many have forgotten that fact. They are living having forgotten it. Having gathered merits with great difficulty to come to this human world to see Nibbana, we have now forgotten the very purpose of our arrival. Because of that forgetfulness, we remain in heedlessness, doing various other things.

We Missed 512,000 Buddha Sasana Without Attaining Nibbana

One does not need a Buddha Sasana to do ordinary things. During the time a Buddha Sasana is available, one must strive without delay to see Nibbana and realize the Four Noble Truths. That is exactly why we came to this human world.

Because we have forgotten the reason for our birth in the human world, we are losing the opportunity to find refuge within this Buddha Sasana. Devotees, it is mentioned in the Dhamma that during the time our Bodhisatta was fulfilling perfections, he encountered 512,000 Buddhas. In this long Samsara, you, I, and all of us encountered Buddha Sasana in this same way, yet we missed them. In those times, we failed to realize a refuge, a protection, or a way out to be liberated from this journey of Samsara.

If we had succeeded, we would not be here today, traveling without seeing a path to end this journey. Even today, we do not possess the wisdom to see where or how Samsara will end. That wisdom arises only when we gradually practice within the Dhamma preached by the Fortunate Lord Buddha.

We Who Have Taken Refuge in the Triple Gem

Think, reflect: we took refuge in the Gem of Buddha with the words "**Buddham Saranam Gacchami**". We took refuge in the Gem of Dhamma with "**Dhammam Saranam Gacchami**". We took refuge in the Gem of Sangha with "**Sangham Saranam Gacchami**".

If we, who have taken refuge in the Triple Gem, pass away without gaining a refuge or protection from the Buddha, Dhamma, and Sangha—without realizing the Four Noble Truths in this life—what will happen to us? That refuge, that help, will slip away from us. This Buddha Sasana, too, will be missed, just as those previous Buddha Sasana were missed.

Therefore, we must think and reflect: having performed past merits and possessing those merits, we have arrived in this human world and gained a human birth (manussātmabhāva paṭilābha). If we depart from this human life without realizing the Four Noble Truths, passing away without Dhamma realization, it is a great misfortune! A great tragedy!

There Was Merit to Become an Arahant

Look at what the Buddha said to Venerable Ananda on one occasion. "Ananda, do you see that son of the Chief wealthy man (Mahadhana setthi putta)?" Pointing to the wealthy man's son who was begging on the street, He asked Ananda. "Yes, O Fortunate One," Ananda replied.

"Ananda, if this son of the Chief Wealthy man had managed his businesses well in the first stage of his life, he would not have fallen to the streets like this today. He would have become the foremost wealthy man in this city. However, Ananda, if he had renounced his wealth and businesses and ordained within this Buddha Sasana during

that first stage of life, he had the merit to become an Arahant. He had the causes to attain Arahantship."

There Was Merit to Become an Anagami

Then, the Buddha mentioned this again: "Ananda, if this wealthy man's son had managed his businesses well in the second stage of his life, he would have become the second most prominent wealthy man in this city. But if he had renounced and ordained during that second stage, he had the merit to become an Anagami (Non-Returner). He had the causes to attain the fruit of Anagami."

There Was Merit to Become a Sakadagami

Furthermore, the Buddha stated: "Ananda, if this wealthy man's son had managed his businesses well even in the final stage of his life, he would have become the third most prominent wealthy man in this city. But if he had ordained during that final stage, he had the merit to become a Sakadagami (Once-Returner). He had the causes to attain the fruit of Sakadagami."

We Too Are People with Great Past Merit

See then, devotees: the capacity for Nibbana, the wholesome potential for Nibbana, has been brought forward by you and me from past Samsara based on merit. Therefore, we must look within and "read" the past merit we possess. After reading that past merit, we must strive to realize the Four Noble Truths in this life.

We must also look at those who attained Nibbana in this Buddha Sasana through their past merit: what did they receive because of that merit? We can read our own past merit by seeing if the things they received are also present in our lives. If they are, we can say: "Yes! We too possess the necessary resources and causes to see

Nibbana through past merit. We, too, are people with great past merit."

With that "reading," we must understand: "The potential and capacity for Nibbana exist within us too; we must identify that potential and develop it bit by bit."

Furthermore, devotees, there is a distance one can travel through aspiration—performing past merit and wishing for Nibbana. You, I, and all of us have already traveled the maximum distance possible through mere aspiration. From this point forward, aspiration alone will not be enough to reach Nibbana in this life.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

In the next sermon, we will mention to you: what did those who possessed past merit receive in order to realize the Four Noble Truths? To what point can one come through aspiration alone? We hope to preach those details in the next session.

Therefore, you must think and reflect based on this discourse:

- We have gathered past merits for a long time in Samsara.
- We have performed merits in this specific way.
- We came to this human world having gathered these past merits.
- We have arrived in this human world specifically to attain Nibbana.
- I have now forgotten that purpose.

This discourse reminds you to remember that purpose once more: "I must attain Nibbana in this life, in this Buddha Sasana." At the beginning of the next sermon, we will discuss how those who attained

Nibbana received the necessary things due to past merit, and we must identify if those things have been granted to us as well.

With the intention of starting the next sermon from that point, we conclude this discourse for now. May this noble and great merit of listening to the Dhamma be a cause and a fortune for the realization of the Four Noble Truths!

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 04
- The Possession of Past Merits (Part 02)

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

Today is the fourth sermon of this series

Compassionate Buddhist devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who listen to the Dhamma through the 'Oghatarana Daham Sangrahaya' YouTube channel: You are preparing to join us for yet another Dhamma sermon today. This is the fourth discourse we are presenting to you.

In the previous three sermons, we reminded you of several things: in the first, an introduction to the 'Oghatarana Margaya' sermon series; in the second, the sequence of the sermons; and in the third, we conducted a discourse on the first topic of that sequence, "The Possession of Past Merits." Today, we bring to you the second part of that specific topic through this sermon.

May this Dhamma sermon be a cause and a fortune for all of you, and for all beings in the world, including gods and Brahmas, to realize the Dhamma! With that aspiration, we begin this discourse.

But We Do Not Know About It

Devotees, while conducting the sermon on "The Possession of Past Merits," we mentioned that we would provide you the opportunity to

listen to this topic in two parts. In the first part, we spoke about how we performed merits in previous Buddha Sasana and throughout Samsara, and the things we aspired for. Having performed those merits and aspired for Nibbana, we have arrived in this life having gained a human birth—a state where that aspiration can be fulfilled—along with the capacity and the wholesome potential to see Nibbana.

But we do not know this; we do not see it. We haven't identified it. We haven't "read" it within ourselves. We came to this human world wanting to see Nibbana, but now we have forgotten that fact. Our lives are passing away as days, weeks, months, and years. If life passes away like this, it is of no use. The merit, the capacity, and the resources we brought with us to see Nibbana will slip away from us in this life.

We reminded you of the story of the son of the Chief Wealthy-man (Mahadhana Setthiputta). If we are like him, we too will have to depart from this life without gaining a refuge or protection within this Buddha Sasana, and without realizing the Four Noble Truths. We also discussed how far one can travel through mere aspiration, the need to recognize that distance, and what must be done once that point is reached.

Rare Things are Granted Only to Those with Merit

Furthermore, we mentioned that we would share with you what those who possessed past merit received within this Buddha Sasana—using that merit as a condition—to see Nibbana. We noted that if the things granted to them are also available to us, it serves as evidence to identify that we, too, possess the past merit necessary for Nibbana.

So, let us see: have the things received by those who realized Nibbana in this Buddha Sasana been granted to us as well?

Devotees, it is only to those with merit that rare things are granted. To receive rare things is a sign of possessing merit. When we hear the word "rare," things like gold, silver, pearls, gems, and money might come to mind. It is our worldly intellect that feels these things are rare. But devotees, can gold, silver, gems, money, or vehicles liberate us from the suffering of birth, old-age, sickness, and death? Can they free us from this cruel, harsh, and terrifying Samsara? No. No matter how rare a thing is, it is of no use if it cannot be used to become free from suffering.

By Now, We Have Already Traveled a Great Distance Within the Dhamma

We often fail to think: "If something can free us from suffering, that is what is truly rare." If we had reflected on what the Supremely Enlightened Buddha called "rare," identified those things with wisdom, and possessed a clear awareness of them, we would have already traveled much further within the Dhamma by now.

Reflect for a moment, devotees. The Lord Buddha mentions five rare things in the Dhamma. What are these five? Have they been received in our lives? If those who attained Nibbana in Samsara encountered these five due to past merit and used them as conditions for their liberation, how did they do it? This is what we must contemplate.

The Arising of a Supremely Enlightened Buddha is Rare in the World

The first rare thing The Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma is: "**Buddhuppādo dullabho lokasmiṃ**"—The arising of a Buddha is rare.

The Lord Buddha states this after looking through the infinite great wisdom at the thirty-one planes of existence, the ten-thousand-fold galaxies, and the 10 million of galaxies with their endless suns, moons, and stars. As the fortunate one examined these galaxies one by one, the Lord Buddha saw that the arising of a Supremely Enlightened Buddha in this world system is extremely rare. This is the very first rare occurrence. Even when looking back through vast periods of time, the appearance of a Lord Buddha is rare. Having seen this with the Buddha-intuition, The fortunate one preached about the arising of a Buddha (Buddhuppāda) with great compassion.

To even hear that a Buddha has arisen is the first rare thing we encounter in this world. We must identify and "read" this fact. Devotees, the reason we have been able to find refuge in The Lord Buddha by saying "Buddhaṃ saranaṃ gacchāmi" during the existence of this Buddha Sasana is nothing other than the past merit we gathered in Samsara. Therefore, the first rare thing to be found in this world has already been received in our lives.

To Gain a Human Birth is Rare

As the Lord Buddha examined the world in various ways, the fortunate one saw the second rare thing: to obtain a human birth is rare. He preached "**Manussatta paṭilābho dullabho**." Within this world system—across the ten thousand and 10 million of galaxies with their infinite suns and stars—the Lord Buddha saw that for someone to obtain a human birth is exceedingly rare. Thus, He mentions this as the second rarity.

If you reflect: "The Lord Buddha preached that human birth is rare. With what depth of investigation did the fortunate one preach this? How much merit must I have to have received this opportunity in this very life?"—you can contemplate this in many ways. Furthermore, when you investigate how you obtained this human

birth, you can identify how your past merit acted as the condition. So, we have encountered the arising of a Buddha, and we have also obtained a human birth.

The Endowment of Faith is Rare

When The Lord Buddha further examined the world, the fortunate one preached the next rarity: "**Dullabhā saddhā sampatti**"—The endowment of faith is rare.

The Lord Buddha sees this "Endowment of Faith" (Saddha Sampatti) as a rarity. Think, reflect: when the Lord Buddhas arise in the world, they preach the Nine Supreme Qualities of The Lord Buddha—that the fortunate one is Arahaṃ, Sammā Sambuddho, Vijjācaraṇasampanno, Sugato, Lokavidū, Anuttaro Purisadammasārathi, Satthā Devamanussānaṃ, Buddho, Bhagavā. If someone has clarity, trust, and belief in these qualities within their mindstream, and if they have trust, belief and clarity in the qualities of the Dhamma and the Sangha, we can say that Faith exists within their mind.

In this world of gods, humans, and Brahmas, The Lord Buddha sees that this faith exists in the hearts of only a very few people. Thus, the fortunate one preached that the endowment of faith is rare.

Some People's Hearts are Overflowing with Faith

If you look closely, the hearts of many people are overflowing with anger, hatred, resentment, grudge, jealousy, pride, and greed. But a person with faith is not like that. They have largely freed their mind from those states; they possess a firm belief in Action and its consequences, they understand this world and the next, they seek the path to Nibbana, and they live by avoiding unwholesome deeds

and committing to the wholesome, such as observing the five precepts.

In this world and society, it is extremely rare to see such people. The reason is the lack of faith in their hearts. Not just in this world, but as The Lord Buddha examined the infinite galaxies in various ways, The fortunate one saw this as the third rarity. If this quality exists to some degree within our mindstream, it means we have fulfilled the third rarity in our lives.

We received this third rarity for no other reason than our past merit. Because we repeatedly cultivated faith throughout Samsara, it exists as a habit within our mindstream in this life as well. We see that while some have a little faith, others' hearts are overflowing with it. Therefore, if you possess the endowment of faith, it was granted by past merit. We are people with a lot of merit.

One Needs Great Merit to Become Ordained

Next, The Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma: "**Pabbajitabhāvo dullabho**"—Ordination is rare.

For the lay devotees listening to this, this hasn't been achieved in this human life yet. However, obtaining ordination within a Buddha Sasana is a rarity. One needs great merit to become a monk. For us to have received ordination in this life is due to nothing else but our past merit—perhaps by seeing others ordain and practice virtue, stillness, and wisdom in previous Buddha Sasana and wishing, "May I also receive this auspicious ordination somewhere in Samsara!" It is the result of that aspiration and the gathering of wholesome deeds. This is why we wear this robe. Even today, many tell us, "We are too late now to wear the robe," or "We wish we could ordain, but our merit is insufficient." They aspire to ordain at least in the next life. Such an aspiration is good; it will become a cause for you to receive

auspicious ordination. This is the fourth rarity mentioned by The Lord Buddha.

Listening to the Sublime Dhamma is Rare

The next thing The Lord Buddha mentions is the hearing of the Dhamma: "**Saddhammasavanaṃ dullabhaṃ**"—To hear the Sublime Dhamma is rare.

Consider Alara Kalama and Uddaka Ramaputta. A Lord Buddha had arisen in the world. Eight weeks after the enlightenment of the fortunate one, on the Esala Full Moon Poya Day, the Lord Buddha set the Wheel of Dhamma in motion. Alara Kalama and Uddaka Ramaputta had encountered the arising of a Buddha, and they had obtained human births. But they were unable to investigate the qualities of The Lord Buddha, Dhamma, and Sangha. Even though they had suppressed the five hindrances and possessed concentrated minds, because they missed the opportunity to hear the Dhamma, they missed Nibbana. When The Lord Buddha, having accepted the invitation from Maha Brahma Sahampathi, investigated whom the fortunate one should teach first, and thought:

Alara Kalama is a great loser

The Fortunate One thought: "To whom shall I first teach the Dhamma? Who will understand this Four Noble Truths quickly?" Then the Fortunate One thought: "This Alara Kalama is wise, learned, and has long had little dust of defilements. It would be well if I taught him first; he would understand quickly." Then a hidden deity informed to the Fortunate One: "Lord, Alara Kalama passed away seven days ago." Through own supreme knowledge of the fortunate one, The Lord Buddha also knew this. Then the Fortunate One thought: "Alara Kalama is a great loser. Had he heard this Dhamma, he would have understood it quickly."

Uddaka Ramaputta is a great loser

Next, the Fortunate One thought of Uddaka Ramaputta. He was also wise and learned. But a hidden deity informed to the Fortunate One: "Lord, Uddaka Ramaputta passed away last night." The Lord Buddha knew this too. The Fortunate One thought: "Uddaka Ramaputta is a great loser. Had he heard this Dhamma, he would have understood it quickly."

See then, devotees: because they lacked the opportunity to hear the Dhamma, they could not realize it. If we examine the Apadana Pali—the life stories of the great noble monks and nuns—we see that they obtained the Gautama Buddha Sasana and human birth exactly as they had aspired. They possessed faith in the Triple Gem. What they received; we have also received in our lives. If we understand and reflect on these rare things being present in our lives, we can say: "According to the Dhamma, I have past merits. I have past wholesome deeds. If I develop the capacity to see Nibbana, I can attain it within this Buddha Sasana."

What Must Be Done Next, to Realize the Four Noble Truths?

To realize Nibbana, one needs the arising of a Buddha, human birth, the endowment of faith, ordination, and the hearing of the Dhamma. Those who received these through past merit—what did they do next, to realize the Four Noble Truths? What did they seek? How did they act within the Dhamma? This is what we must examine next.

Once those who have past merit understand that they possess these conditions, what is the next step? How should we travel toward Nibbana? In the next sermon, we hope to explain the next action required to realize the Four Noble Truths.

Summary of Today's Sermon

We mentioned today that:

- The five rare things mentioned by The Lord Buddha are granted only to those with past merit.
- In the ordinary world, gold and gems seem rare, but true rarity lies in the factors that can end the suffering of Samsara.
- The Lord Buddha, having examined the entire universe with the wisdom, pointed out five extremely rare things.

Those five rare things are:

1. Buddhuppādo dullabho lokasmiṃ: The arising of a Buddha is extremely rare.
2. Manussatta paṭilābho dullabho: To obtain a human birth is extremely rare.
3. Dullabhā saddhā sampatti: The arising of faith in the Triple Gem is rare.
4. Pabbajitabhāvo dullabho: To obtain ordination is rare.
5. Saddhammasavanaṃ dullabhaṃ: To get the opportunity to hear the Sublime Dhamma is rare.

How these apply to you:

- When you were born, The Buddha Sasana exists in the world (Buddhuppāda).
- You have obtained a human life (Manussatta paṭilābha).
- You have faith in the qualities of the Triple Gem in your heart (Saddhā sampatti).
- Even if lay devotees are not ordained, they can still attain the fruits of the path (Magga Phala) to end suffering.
- You are able to hear the pure Dhamma (Saddhammasavana).

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

May the merit of listening to this Dhamma be a cause and a fortune for all of you to realize the Auspicious Four Noble Truths and find peace in the Great Immortal Nibbana! May it be an auspicious perfection!

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 05
- The Association with Good Spiritual Friends

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

Today marks the fifth sermon in this series

Compassionate Buddhist devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who listen to the Dhamma through the Oghatarana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel: You are preparing to join us for another Dhamma sermon today. This fifth discourse is what we hope to present to you.

Rare Things are Granted Only to Those with Merit

In our previous sermon, we spoke about the things we receive by conditioning our past merits. We mentioned that rare things are granted to those with merit. Conversely, receiving rare things is proof that one possesses merit. As rare things, the Fortunate One mentioned in the Dhamma:

1. The Arising of a Buddha is rare.
2. To gain a human birth is rare.
3. The endowment of faith is rare.
4. Ordination is rare.
5. The hearing of the Sublime Dhamma is rare.

We mentioned that these things were granted to us because of the merits—the wholesome deeds—we performed in previous lives, such as serving the Buddha, practicing generosity, virtue, and meditation. When we performed those deeds, we aspired: "Through this, may I realize the Four Noble Truths quickly and easily, and may I be liberated from this gruesome, harsh, and terrifying Samsara!" It is because of those aspirations and merits that we have received these rare opportunities today.

These were granted to us so that we can realize Nibbana. Now, we have received them, but as we discussed before, the urgency and the necessity to realize Nibbana have slipped away from us in this life. We reminded you that you came to this human life specifically to see Nibbana. This is how you thought and reflected in previous lives. Following that thought, you now have the resources needed for Nibbana. You must investigate these matters and act to become free from suffering.

We Have Missed This Opportunity in Previous Buddha Sasana

We noted that if we do not encounter a Buddha's arising, if we do not gain a human birth, or if we miss out on faith, ordination, and hearing the Dhamma, the opportunity to see Nibbana within this Buddha Sasana will slip away. Therefore, we must not let this opportunity escape us in this life. We mentioned that we have likely missed this opportunity in previous Buddha Sasana. If we miss it now, devotees, we will have to wait in Samsara until another Buddha Sasana arises with all these conditions met once more.

Reflect on this: these are the exact factors that helped, supported, and conditioned those who successfully realized Nibbana in this Buddha Sasana. While we might think gold, silver, gems, and property are rare, we noted that these things cannot liberate us from birth, old-age, sickness, and death. If one wishes to realize the Four Noble

Truths, one must fulfill these rare conditions as the "capital" for one's life. This is the distance one can travel through the merit and aspirations gathered since previous lives—obtaining a Buddha Sasana, a human birth, faith, ordination, and the hearing of the Sublime Dhamma. We mentioned that if anyone realizes Nibbana in this Sasana, they do so based on these conditions.

Have You Looked for Good Spiritual Friends?

Next, devotees, we must investigate what those who received these things through past merit did afterward. Look closely: those who received these things went in search of Good Spiritual Friends. Look at Upatissa and Kolita (Sariputta and Moggallana); what did they do? They went searching for Good Spiritual Friends. Many others who had conditioned their past merits also went in search of such friends.

Devotees, think about your own lives. We looked for good friends, we looked for good teachers when we were young, we looked for good clothes, and we looked for good vehicles. But have we ever searched with the thought: "I need to associate with a Good Spiritual Friend"? Have you truly looked for Good Spiritual Friends? Reflect deeply—we haven't. We haven't felt that necessity. We don't even have a clear internal definition of what a Good Spiritual Friend truly is. Devotees, if the association with a Good Spiritual Friend is not achieved based on your past merit, the realization of the Four Noble Truths simply will not happen.

The Fortunate One is the Supreme Good Spiritual Friend

Look at the five first disciples at Isipatana deer park. When they met the Lord Buddha and the Fortunate One set the Wheel of Dhamma in motion, the ascetic Kondanna, having heard that Dhamma, realized the Truth.

First, we must define who a Good Spiritual Friend is. When the Lord Buddha first had the opportunity by turning the Wheel of Dhamma, The Fortunate One mentioned at the very beginning of the discourse that the Fortunate One Himself is a Good Spiritual Friend. By abandoning the two extremes—sensual indulgence and self-mortification—and arriving at the Noble Eightfold Path, the Fortunate One attained Supreme Enlightenment.

The Fortunate Lord Buddha preached what this Noble Eightfold Path is. He taught that it is only by arriving at this Path that suffering can be ended. Devotees, if someone can correctly and systematically describe the Path, its landmarks, and how to arrive at the Noble Eightfold Path, we call that person a Good Spiritual Friend.

Therefore, the Ultimate Good Spiritual Friend who can perfectly describe the Path and its landmarks is the Tathagata, the Supremely Enlightened Lord Buddha. Endowed with infinite wisdom—such as the knowledge of the inclinations and underlying tendencies of beings (Asaya Anusaya Ñāṇa), the knowledge of past lives, and the knowledge of the maturity of the spiritual faculties of others—the Perfectly self-enlightened Lord Buddha has the unique ability in this Dhamma to show the various landmarks required for an individual to reach the Noble Eightfold Path. No one else in this Buddha Sasana possesses that specific capacity to the same degree. Because of this, the Lord Buddha is called the Ultimate Good Spiritual Friend. Devotees, if the Lord Buddha had not discovered this Noble Eightfold Path Himself and preached it without a teacher's guidance, no one would ever have the chance to hear about the Path or its landmarks. For this reason, too, the Lord Buddha is the Ultimate Good Spiritual Friend.

Those with Past Merit Went in Search of Good Spiritual Friends

It is through this Good Spiritual Friendship that many beings crossed over the sufferings of birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, pain, grief, and despair. Those who followed the path and the landmarks preached by Him realized the Four Noble Truths and crossed the ocean of Samsara.

Therefore, you must reflect. To realize the Dhamma and enter the Noble Eightfold Path, we must use our past merit to find and associate with a Good Spiritual Friend who can show us the path and the landmarks correctly. Devotees, you possess great past merit. If you search for Good Spiritual Friends—those noble ones who preach the Noble Eightfold Path and the systematic way to reach it—you will undoubtedly find them because of your merit.

Those with past merit always went looking for Good Spiritual Friends. If you investigate those who realized Nibbana in this Sasana, you will see that the primary reason they could do so in such a short time was the association with a Good Spiritual Friend.

"Ananda! Do not say so."

I wish to present a few Sutta discourses here that describe the Good Spiritual Friend.

Ekamantaṃ nisinnō khō rājā Pasenadi Kōsalō Bhagavantaṃ ētadavōca: Idha mayhaṃ bhantē rahōgatassa paṭisallīnassa ēvaṃ cētasō parivitakkō udapādi: Svākkhātō Bhagavatā Dhammō. Sō ca khō kalyāṇamittassa kalyāṇasahāyassa kalyāṇasampavaṅkassa nō pāpamittassa nō pāpasahāyassa nō pāpasampavaṅkassāti. Ēvamētaṃ mahārāja, ēvamētaṃ mahārāja, svākkhātō mahārāja mayā Dhammō. Sō ca khō kalyāṇamittassa kalyāṇasahāyassa

kalyāṇasampavaṅkassa. Nō pāpamittassa nō pāpasahāyassa nō pāpasampavaṅkassāti.

Ēkamidāhaṃ mahārāja, samayaṃ Sakkēsu viharāmi Nāgarakaṃ nāma Sakyānaṃ nigamō. Atha khō mahārāja Ānandō bhikkhū yēnāhaṃ tēnupasaṅkami. Upasaṅkamitvā maṃ abhivādētvā ēkamantaṃ nisīdi. Ēkamantaṃ nisinnō khō mahārāja Ānandō bhikkhū maṃ ētadavōca: Upaḍḍhamidaṃ bhantē brahmacariyassa yadidaṃ kalyāṇamittatā kalyāṇasahāyatā kalyāṇasampavaṅkatāti. Ēvaṃ vuttāhaṃ mahārāja Ānandaṃ bhikkhūṃ ētadavōcaṃ: Mā hēvaṃ Ānanda, mā hēvaṃ Ānanda, sakalamēva hidaṃ Ānanda brahmacariyaṃ yadidaṃ kalyāṇamittatā kalyāṇasahāyatā kalyāṇasampavaṅkatā. Kalyāṇamittassētaṃ Ānanda bhikkhunō pāṭikaṅkhaṃ kalyāṇasahāyassa kalyāṇasampavaṅkassa ariyaṃ aṭṭhaṅgikaṃ maggaṃ bhāvēssati, ariyaṃ aṭṭhaṅgikaṃ maggaṃ bahulīkarissati.

Sitting to one side, King Pasenadi of Kosala addressed the Fortunate One in this way: "Lord, while I was in seclusion and solitude, this reflection arose in my mind: 'The Dhamma has been well-proclaimed by the Fortunate One. Yet, that is for one who has Good spiritual friends, good companions, and good associates; it is not for one with evil friends, evil companions, and evil associates.'"

"So it is, Great King! So, it is! Great King, the Dhamma I have preached is well-proclaimed. It is indeed for one with Good spiritual friends, good companions, and good associates; it is not for one with evil friends, evil companions, and evil associates."

"Great King, once I was staying among the Sakyans in a market town named Nagaraka. At that time, Great King, the venerable Ananda approached me. Having approached and paid homage to me, he sat to one side. Sitting to one side, Great King, the venerable Ananda said this to me: 'Lord, this Good spiritual friendship, good companionship,

and good association is half of the holy life.' When he had said this, Great King, I told the venerable Ananda: 'Do not say so, Ananda! Do not say so, Ananda! This Good spiritual friendship, good companionship, and good association is the entire holy life. Ananda, it is to be expected of a monk with Good spiritual friends, good companions, and good associates, that he will develop the Noble Eightfold Path and cultivate the Noble Eightfold Path.'"

Devotees, I am reminded of several Suttas at this moment. It is valuable to remind you of these points. As mentioned, the Fortunate One corrected Ananda Thero, stating that the entire Buddha Sasana rests upon the Noble Friend.

The Entire Holy Life Depends on the Good Spiritual Friend

Atha khō āyasmā Sāriputtō yēna Bhagavā tēnupasaṅkami. Upasaṅkamitvā Bhagavantaṃ abhivādētvā ēkamantaṃ nisīdi. Ēkamantaṃ nisinnō khō āyasmā Sāriputtō Bhagavantaṃ ētadavōca: Sakalamēvidaṃ bhantē, brahmacariyaṃ yadidaṃ kalyāṇamittatā kalyāṇasahāyatā kalyāṇasampavaṅkatāti. Sādhu, sādhu, Sāriputta, sakalamēvidaṃ Sāriputta brahmacariyaṃ yadidaṃ kalyāṇamittatā kalyāṇasahāyatā kalyāṇasampavaṅkatā. Kalyāṇamittassētaṃ Sāriputta, bhikkhunō pāṭikaṅkhaṃ kalyāṇasahāyassa kalyāṇasampavaṅkassa ariyaṃ aṭṭhaṅgikaṃ maggaṃ bhāvēssati, ariyaṃ aṭṭhaṅgikaṃ maggaṃ bahulīkarissati.

Then, Venerable Sariputta approached the Fortunate One. Having approached and paid homage to the Fortunate One, he sat to one side. Sitting to one side, Venerable Sariputta addressed the Fortunate One in this way: "Lord, this Good spiritual friendship, good companionship, and good association is indeed the entire Holy Life."

"Excellent, excellent, Sariputta! Sariputta, this Good spiritual friendship, good companionship, and good association is indeed the

entire Holy Life. Sariputta, it is to be expected of a monk with Good spiritual friends, good companions, and good associates, that he will develop the Noble Eightfold Path and cultivate the Noble Eightfold Path."

Look at this, devotees; in the Sariputta Sutta, on that occasion, the Great Arahant Sariputta encountered the Lord Buddha and inquired from the Fortunate Lord Buddha, "Lord, the entirety of this Holy Life depend upon the Good spiritual friend, does it not?" At that moment, devotees, the Lord Buddha, saying, "Sadhu! Sadhu! Sariputta! Sadhu! Sadhu! Sariputta!" preached back in that very same manner, confirming that the entire Holy Life indeed depends upon the Good spiritual friend. The Lord Buddha gave His solemn approval to that statement.

The Dawn is the Forerunner to the Rising Sun

In the Kalyāṇamitta Sutta, the Lord Buddha states:

Suriyassa bhikkhave, udayatō ētaṃ pubbaṅgamaṃ etaṃ pubbanimittaṃ yadidaṃ aruṇaggaṃ. ēvamēva khō bhikkhave, bhikkhunō ariyassa aṭṭhaṅgikassa maggassa uppādāya ētaṃ pubbaṅgamaṃ ētaṃ pubbanimittaṃ, yadidaṃ kalyāṇamittatā. kalyāṇamittassētaṃ bhikkhave, bhikkhunō pāṭikaṅkhaṃ: ariyaṃ aṭṭhaṅgikaṃ maggaṃ bhāvēssati, ariyaṃ aṭṭhaṅgikaṃ maggaṃ bahulīkarissati.

"Monks, just as the dawn is the forerunner and the precursor to the rising of the sun, even so, monks, for a monk, Good spiritual friendship is the forerunner and the precursor to the arising of the Noble Eightfold Path. Monks, it is to be expected of a monk with Good spiritual friends that he will develop the Noble Eightfold Path and cultivate the Noble Eightfold Path."

Devotees, many of us have gone to worship Sri Pada (Adam's Peak). One thing pilgrim do with great joy is watch the "Ira Sevaya" (the sunrise). Before the sun actually appears, you know it is coming because of the dawn—the reddening of the eastern sky. The dawn is the precursor to the sunrise.

In the Kalyāṇamitta Sutta, the Buddha explains that just as the dawn means the sun will rise in a few moments, the association with a Good Spiritual Friend is the precursor to the arising of the Noble Eightfold Path. To enter that Path, one must have the association of a Good Spiritual Friend.

I want to explain this a bit further. Once the dawn appears, it doesn't take hours for the sun to rise from the eastern sky; it happens very quickly. Look at the time frame given in that simile. Similarly, once someone meets a Good Spiritual Friend, hears the path and the landmarks clearly, and enters the Noble Eightfold Path, it does not take a long time to realize the Four Noble Truths.

Association with a Good Spiritual Friend is the First Factor of Stream-Entry

Furthermore, the very first factor of Stream-Entry (Sotāpatti anga) is the association with a Good Spiritual Friend. The Dhamma describes the Good Spiritual Friend through many such discourses. We have all heard about Good Spiritual Friends. But devotees, why do we delay in finding them? The first thing to do is to find a Good Spiritual Friend to associate with. If not, we will be delayed in learning about the Noble Eightfold Path, path and landmarks to arriving at the Noble Eightfold Path. If you delay in finding a Good Spiritual Friend to listen to the Dhamma, the entry into the Noble Path will not happen.

We haven't defined or thought within the Dhamma

Since we have recognized that we have past merit, the next step is to search for Good Spiritual Friends. In this Buddha Sasana, those who had the merit to see Nibbana, Next searched for a Good Spiritual Friend. Therefore, all of us who recognize our possession of past merits must now go in search of Good Spiritual Friends. If we do, you, I, and all of us will be able to realize the Four Noble Truths very quickly and easily, without taking a long time. Reflect deeply on these matters.

Your next task is to find Good Spiritual Friends. In this sermon, we have explained that "Good Spiritual Friends must be obtained" as a result of past merit. You must reflect and go in search of them. Yes, that's true, but until now we haven't defined or thought about Good Spiritual Friends in this way within the Dhamma. If a clear mindfulness and wisdom regarding Good Spiritual Friends had arisen in your heart before this, you would have already found them. If you had, it wouldn't have taken long for you—who already have past merit—to encounter them. Do you understand? If you had "read" and understood regarding the Good Spiritual Friend, you would recognize them at various temples or forest monasteries. To recognize a Good Spiritual Friend, you must have studied what the Dhamma says about them.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

You must clearly recognize the necessity of a Good Spiritual Friend to enter the Noble Path. This mindfulness and wisdom must exist within you. Think carefully about what you must do now. If not, we will continue to delay our journey toward Nibbana. The easiest, simplest, and fastest way to see Nibbana in this life is for you—who already have past merit—to find Good Spiritual Friends.

May this merit of listening to Dhamma be a cause for you to find Good Spiritual Friends! May the merit of this listening to Dhamma lead you to the Noble Eightfold Path and the realization of the Four Noble Truths, and may it lead to the peace of the Great Immortal Nibbana! With that aspiration, we conclude this Dhamma sermon.

May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of these meritorious ones!

- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 06
- Listening to the true Dhamma

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

So, today, this is the sixth sermon of it

Compassionate Buddhist devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who are listening to the Dhamma through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel; these devotees are preparing to join with us today with yet another Dhamma sermon.

This is the sixth Dhamma sermon that we are performing in this sermon series, which we hope to present to you.

So, Devotees, in the first, second, third, fourth, and fifth sermons, what we performed was:

- In the first sermon, the introduction regarding this sermon series.
- In the second sermon, regarding the sequence of the sermons.
- In the third and fourth sermons, under the title "The possession of prior merit," two Dhamma sermons were performed.
- Through the fifth sermon, the matter regarding "Meeting Good spiritual friends" was explained.

This hearing of the True Dhamma is extremely rare

Then, regarding the manner of meeting Good spiritual friends by having prior merit as a condition, we explained to you devotees within that fifth sermon. So, by having prior merit as a condition, Good spiritual friends are met. After that, what we have is to discuss with you devotees within today's sermon regarding the matter of "Listening to the True Dhamma."

Devotees, regarding the matter of listening to the Dhamma, you devotees must think very well and deeply. **Saddhammasavanam atidullabham**—it is preached that "the hearing of this True Dhamma is extremely rare."

The True Dhamma well-preached by the Fortunate Lord Buddha

Devotees, regarding this extremely rare True Dhamma, regarding the very first quality of the Dhamma, we must think well. We must contemplate. The first quality in the Dhamma is **Svākkhāto Bhagavatā Dhammo**. Through the first quality, what is mentioned is that the Fortunate Lord Buddha has well-preached this True Dhamma. Devotees, saying that this Dhamma was well-preached means that regarding the beginning, the middle, and the end—that is, regarding these matters called Virtue, Stillness, and Wisdom—the Fortunate One has well-preached the Dhamma to us.

The next quality in the Dhamma

After that, the next quality in the Dhamma is the quality of **Sandiṭṭhika**. For what purpose? It is for seeing this Dhamma within oneself that the Fortunate Lord Buddha well-preached this beginning, middle, and end. Then, one must see within oneself this True Dhamma that was well-preached by the Fortunate Lord Buddha. It must be seen within each person's own self. It is precisely when

seeing this True Dhamma within each person's own self, devotees, that we arrive towards the Noble Eightfold Path in order and realize the Four Noble Truths. We see the Four Noble Truths.

Then devotees, if one has well-seen regarding that Dhamma within oneself, if one has seen those various natures of the Dhamma as they truly are, then the extremely profound meaning within that Dhamma can be well-opened, analyzed, divided into parts, and established by the person who saw that Dhamma. When it is thus well-opened, analyzed, and divided into parts, we can see that Dhamma very easily and comfortably.

That is why it is said that a Good spiritual friend must be found

So devotees, the association of a Good spiritual friend connects to the hearing of the True Dhamma from right there. A "Good spiritual friend" is someone who has arrived at the Noble Eightfold Path, and having arrived at the Noble Eightfold Path, if he preaches to someone regarding the Noble Eightfold Path, the way, and the signs of the way—then he is the one. Then, to the person who gives us advice and instructions to travel along that way and those signs of the way, having seen that way and those signs of the way preached by the Fortunate Lord Buddha to be liberated from suffering, we call a "Good spiritual friend."

So the person who saw the Dhamma, if he says he knows and sees that True Dhamma well-preached by the Fortunate Lord Buddha within himself in order, it means he realized the beginning as the beginning, the middle as the middle, and the end as the end. In the same way, to those who come towards him, he preaches that Dhamma in order. First, he preaches the beginning as the beginning. Secondly, he preaches the middle as the middle. Thirdly, he preaches the end as the end. So, that is why it is said that a Good spiritual friend must be found.

Within this Dhamma, they abandon searching for Nibbāna in this life

Devotees, you also think and see, within this Dhamma, whether the wisdom that "we must be disciplined correctly in order from the beginning" exists within us. See if you are disciplined within this Dhamma from the beginning in order with that wisdom. Devotees, we see the majority, many people, having abandoned this beginning and having abandoned the middle, they search for Nibbāna from the end. When those who search for Nibbāna from the end, having abandoned the beginning and abandoned the middle, go on for a little while, devotees, what do they do say "this Dhamma cannot be realized by us within this life"? Within this Dhamma, they abandon searching for Nibbāna in this life.

Devotees, that is not an error in the Dhamma. It is because we did not read the very first quality of the Dhamma correctly within us, and because we did not apply ourselves accordingly, that the "reading" has arisen that says the matter of realizing this Dhamma cannot be done within this life. This searching for Nibbāna, working while searching for Nibbāna, and fulfilling virtuous qualities—we have abandoned it from our lives.

Establish it within yourself correctly in this way

Therefore devotees, if you listen to this Dhamma, which was well-preached at the beginning, middle, and end, in order and if you are disciplined within this Dhamma in order, the **Opanayika quality** (leading onward) which brings you to the next and the next Dhamma nature systematically within this very Dhamma will start to develop the path up to the Noble Eightfold Path. Likewise, you will begin to understand that it is possible for us to realize the Dhamma very quickly and comfortably within this life. Therefore, you devotees

must think. You must contemplate. You must study well regarding the qualities that exist in this Dhamma. Correctly establish within yourself in this way the matter of "how to use and get help from this listening to the True Dhamma to see Nibbāna." To do that, it is necessary to have produced awareness and wisdom well, having thought and contemplated regarding that first quality in the Dhamma.

With extreme kindness, compassion, and a selfless intention, he shows that way

So, a Good spiritual friend is someone who has arrived at the Noble Eightfold Path in order. Then, the person who arrived in order knows and sees, devotees, the matter that one cannot arrive at this Noble Eightfold Path having abandoned the beginning and having abandoned the middle. Then, his instruction is not one where the beginning is abandoned. It is not one where the middle is abandoned. It is a preaching done in order: beginning, middle, and end. Therefore devotees, he sees that it is only within a preaching done in order of beginning, middle, and end that someone can realize this Dhamma.

Then devotees, he never preaches the Dhamma from the end, having forgotten the beginning and having forgotten the middle. Seeing that the opportunity to realize the Dhamma within this Dhamma will be lost to someone by saying a part from the end, a part from the beginning, and a part from the middle, he shows the path correctly. Because he knows the path will go wrong for someone who does not do so, without saying it in parts as a part from the beginning, a part from the middle, and a part from the end, through a sequential preaching, devotees, he helps and assists those who need to be liberated from suffering who come to him. To those who come to him, with extreme kindness, compassion, and a selfless intention, he shows that way. So that is why, devotees, we say again and again that if you are a person who is working to see Nibbāna properly in this

life, you must listen to the Dhamma while associating with a Good spiritual friend.

Because it is preached within the Dhamma to be diligent

So therefore devotees, within the listening to the Dhamma, you must purify the beginning, the Virtue (Sīla), well. Purify the virtue well again and again; then you will understand and see the matter that the Fortunate Lord Buddha has well-preached this Dhamma through yourself while knowing and seeing the Dhamma. Likewise devotees, when dwelling within the Dhamma knowing and seeing the matter of Virtue in that way within yourself, then, you will see how Virtue helps for Stillness (Samādhi), and when working while knowing and seeing well regarding Stillness and the calmness of the mind, and when working while knowing and seeing the manner in which that Stillness becomes a condition for Wisdom to be born—then the mind systematically inclines towards the arising of an unshakable confidence regarding this very Dhamma and regarding the Fortunate Lord Buddha who preached this Dhamma. The mind bends. Faith starts to grow in the mind. Effort starts to grow in the mind. These Dhamma factors called Mindfulness, Stillness, and Wisdom start to grow based precisely on behaving within that Dhamma.

So, take it into contemplation; that is why we reminded you devotees that "prior merit must exist, having prior merit Good spiritual friends must be found, and likewise, having found Good spiritual friends, one must listen to this Dhamma well in its beginning, middle, and end and behave according to that Dhamma." So devotees, when this matter of listening to the Dhamma is received in our lives in this way in this life, we must hold this Dhamma well and behave accordingly. Likewise devotees, as devotees who listen to the Dhamma, you devotees must practice daily for the purpose of seeing Nibbāna in this life along with certain portions of work in the day. Be clever to practice daily along with day-to-day work. Because it is

preached within the Dhamma to be diligent (Appamāda). If it is not so, what happens is becoming negligent.

As the second factor of Stream-entry, listening to the True Dhamma is mentioned

No matter how much Dhamma is heard, if we did not hold that Dhamma well and practice it, that process of "going against the current" which we mentioned earlier—the process where the dust of defilements is abandoned and washed away within our mind stream to see Nibbāna—will not happen. So therefore, the matter of listening to the Dhamma is extremely important, devotees. In the four factors of Stream-entry (Sotāpatti-anga), the Lord Buddha preaches the association of a Good spiritual friend as the very first factor of Stream-entry. The second factor is listening to the True Dhamma. Look, devotees, the association of a Good spiritual friend is mentioned as the first factor of Stream-entry. Listening to the True Dhamma is mentioned as the second factor of Stream-entry. There, the Buddha has very clearly preached these two matters first. Then, devotees, first you must be clever to find Good spiritual friends. Likewise, having found such Good spiritual friends, to listen to the Dhamma.

Think regarding Virtue as well. Contemplate

So, you understood from this sermon today that if you take to practicing the end part, having abandoned the beginning part of this Dhamma and having abandoned the middle part—that through that process, it is difficult for these devotees to achieve that matter of seeing Nibbāna. Let's say someone is now practicing the end without practicing the beginning, and is someone who is now practicing and training in this Dhamma from the very end without practicing the middle. If so, devotees, if that wisdom which you are trying to produce within that Dhamma portion you are practicing has not yet

arisen within you, that is the deficiency in Virtue, the deficiency in Stillness. Then devotees, while working to complete and develop wisdom through that Dhamma portion and that Dhamma method, think regarding that Virtue as well and contemplate. Think regarding Stillness as well and contemplate. In that way, you purify that beginning portion of Virtue again. When you also practice and train in that portion of Virtue, then, based on Virtue, the calmness of your mind, the Stillness, will certainly arise. The five hindrances (Pañcha Nīvarana) will certainly be removed from your mind. Based on that, that deep wisdom mentioned will arise in your mind and the Dhamma will certainly be seen.

May there be the refuge of the Triple Gem to all these devotees!

So therefore devotees, when listening to the Dhamma, if you heard this sermon in order from the beginning, if you practiced this sermon from the beginning, then you will be able to see this Dhamma within yourself very quickly and very comfortably. Therefore devotees, think and contemplate: "In order, step by step within this Dhamma, I am traveling towards the realization of the Four Noble Truths. In order, daily, no matter what exists, I will practice a certain portion of the path to Nibbāna daily in my life, without abandoning it day by day." Then, within this attainment of the human state received by the lay devotees, the ability and the possibility to realize the Four Noble Truths called Suffering, the Origin, the Cessation, and the Path will be received. So, until then, we remind these devotees through this topic of "Listening to the Dhamma" the matter that you should hear this Dhamma in order and practice and train. Next devotees, in the next program, what we have to preach is the next topic: Identifying the Unwholesomeness and Identifying the Wholesomeness. Then, prior merit must exist, Good spiritual friends must be found, and the Dhamma must be heard. Within that hearing of the Dhamma, devotees, the first thing that must happen is

identifying the unwholesomeness and the wholesomeness. So, we hope to perform that under the next topic in the next sermon.

So, may the merit of having heard this Dhamma also be a cause for all these devotees for the very realization of the Four Noble Truths! May you be fortunate! —Wishing thus, I conclude this Dhamma sermon from here.

May there be the refuge of the Triple Gem to all these devotees!

- Oghatharana Margaya (The Path of Crossing the Torrent)
- Sermon No. 07
- Identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Samma Sambuddhassa!

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One! May my homage be offered!

So, today, this is the seventh sermon of it

Compassionate Buddhist Devotees, endowed with faith and wisdom, who are listening to the Dhamma through the Oghatharana Daham Sangrahaya YouTube channel; you devotees are preparing to join with us today with yet another Dhamma sermon. All of you are preparing today as well to connect with the seventh sermon being performed by us.

So, by now, we mentioned that we hope to perform a series of sermons for you devotees by the name Oghatharana Margaya; six sermons of that series have been completed by now.

So, in the past first, second, third, fourth, fifth, and sixth sermons, what we performed, devotees, was:

- In the first sermon: The introduction regarding this sermon series.
- In the second sermon: Regarding the sequence of the sermons.
- In the third and fourth sermons: Two Dhamma sermons were performed under the title "The possession of prior merit."

- Through the fifth sermon: The matter regarding "Association of Good spiritual friends" was explained.
- Through the sixth sermon: The description regarding "Listening to the True Dhamma" was given.

Identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness

Then today, we said we would preach, devotees, regarding the topic "Identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness." Having prior merit as a condition, Good spiritual friends are met. The person who has met a Good spiritual friend, devotees, listens to the Dhamma. From that listening to the Dhamma, devotees, he identifies well within himself: "What is Unwholesomeness? What is Wholesomeness?" He begins to see Unwholesomeness and Wholesomeness within himself. So devotees, these two words, **Unwholesomeness and Wholesomeness**, are two words you devotees have heard since childhood. These words, devotees, we have heard plenty of times—that this is Wholesomeness and this is Unwholesomeness.

Where is this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness born? Where does this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness arise?

We have had the chance to hear "Wholesomeness, Unwholesomeness; Wholesomeness, Unwholesomeness" through various Dhamma sermons and while reading various books. The matter I ask from you devotees is, if you were asked: "Have you seen Wholesomeness? Have you seen Unwholesomeness?"—you devotees think well about it. What is the answer given? "Have I actually seen Wholesomeness? Have I seen Unwholesomeness?" Then devotees, sometimes you might not get an answer to give. It is then that the matter of "I must see Wholesomeness, I must see Unwholesomeness" is even remembered by you devotees.

Then devotees, we must listen well and understand the matter: "How can we see Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness?" Having listened and understood, one must first identify regarding this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness. Devotees, if we are to identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, we must know the nature of Wholesomeness and the nature of Unwholesomeness. Likewise devotees, if we are to see Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, we must know well and must have heard: "Where is this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness born? Where does this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness arise?"

Devotees, if someone asks: "Where does this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness arise? Where is this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness born?"—what is the answer you give him? You must have the ability to give him the answer fearlessly: "This Wholesomeness is born, Wholesomeness arises, and this Unwholesomeness is born, Unwholesomeness arises within one's own mind."

The person who looks towards his own mind can identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness from within his own mind

Then devotees, regarding the matter "What should be done to identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness?"—that also you can tell clearly, in order, and correctly. Devotees, if you are to identify Wholesomeness, if you are to see Wholesomeness, if you are to identify Unwholesomeness, if you are to see Unwholesomeness—now we have learned, now we have heard, that this Wholesomeness is born and this Unwholesomeness is born in one's own mind. Then devotees, the person who looks towards his own mind can identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness from within his own mind. One has to look at one's own mind with the intention of identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness.

Look now devotees, from morning until going to sleep at night, we are just keep looking at this world. Then devotees, when Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness are born within us in our minds, will we get the ability to see them in those respective places, at those respective times, and in those respective moments? Because we spend time looking at the world, searching, and talking about shortcomings with a mind that has abandoned looking towards our own mind and is inclined towards the world. In that way, we will never be able to see Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness within ourselves or identify them within ourselves.

Devotees, if you did not see this Unwholesomeness within yourself, the matter called "abandoning Unwholesomeness" is something that will never ever happen. For the person who did not see Wholesomeness being born within his own mental continuum, within his own mind, devotees, the matter called "developing Wholesomeness" does not happen. Then, if the matter of "abandoning Unwholesomeness and developing Wholesomeness" is to be performed, is to happen, there must be the ability to see well the Wholesomeness born within one's mind as Wholesomeness, and Unwholesomeness as Unwholesomeness.

One must know the nature of Wholesomeness and the nature of Unwholesomeness

Then devotees, all right, if we are to identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, to see Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, you and all of us have now arrived at the point that "one must look towards one's own mind." Next devotees, if we are to mark this as Wholesomeness and this as Unwholesomeness, we must know the nature of Wholesomeness and the nature of Unwholesomeness. It is within that, that we can name this as Wholesomeness and this as Unwholesomeness. Then devotees, if we are asked what the nature of Unwholesomeness is, what is the answer we give? What is the

response we give? If we had not learned within the listening to the Dhamma that "this is the nature of Unwholesomeness," then we would be unable to name Unwholesomeness as Unwholesomeness or to see Unwholesomeness as Unwholesomeness. Likewise, if we did not know what the nature of Wholesomeness is and had not learned it through the listening to the Dhamma, we would be unable to identify or see Wholesomeness within us as "Wholesomeness."

Devotees, then you will have to know well what the nature of Unwholesomeness is. The nature of Unwholesomeness is: it burns our mental continuum. It scorches. It makes it impure. It soils it. It makes it undisciplined. It destroys the restraint that is in our mind. Then devotees, when looking towards your mental continuum, when looking at your mind, if there is a burning nature, a scorching nature, a soiling nature, an undisciplined nature, an impure nature in the mental continuum—you must see that nature as Unwholesomeness. You must mark it as Unwholesome. It is Unwholesomeness that has been born in our mind at that moment.

Then devotees, when looking towards your mental continuum, when looking at your mind, if there is a nature that does not burn the mental continuum, a nature that does not scorch, a nature that does not soil, a disciplined nature, a pure nature, a tamed nature—you must see that nature as Wholesomeness. You must mark it as Wholesomeness. It is Wholesomeness that has been born in our mind at that moment.

This is Unwholesomeness

Devotees, in this way when looking towards your mental continuum, with the intention of identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, or else with the intention of inquiring whether the nature of your mental continuum is now associated with Unwholesomeness or associated with Wholesomeness, when looking

towards your own mind while searching and inquiring, you meet with two natures.

One is the nature of burning the mental continuum, the nature of scorching the mental continuum, the nature of soiling the mental continuum. Likewise, the nature of making it impure. The undisciplined nature. The untamed nature. If it is endowed with this nature, at that moment, having looked towards your mental continuum, you must mark: "This is Unwholesomeness." After that, towards that nature, towards that nature associated with Unwholesomeness, you must direct the mind while labeling again and again, "This is Unwholesomeness." Having directed the mind, you must establish mindfulness. Then Unwholesomeness will be understood by you as Unwholesomeness, while establishing the mind upon it. While establishing the mind upon it, you will be able to be aware Unwholesomeness as Unwholesomeness. Then, when you have well directed the mind towards Unwholesomeness and while labeling "It is Unwholesomeness," as mindfulness becomes established and established within that nature associated with Unwholesomeness, there, devotees, you will get the ability to see Unwholesomeness again and again, as Unwholesomeness.

This is Wholesomeness

Devotees, again, in this way when looking towards your mental continuum, with the intention of identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, or else with the intention of inquiring whether the nature of your mental continuum is now associated with Unwholesomeness or associated with Wholesomeness, when looking towards your own mind while searching and inquiring, you meet to see a nature like this:

A nature of not burning the mental continuum. A nature of not scorching the mental continuum. A nature of not soiling the mental

continuum. Likewise, a nature that makes it pure. A disciplined nature. A tamed nature. If it is endowed with this nature, at that moment, having looked towards your mental continuum, you must mark: "This is Wholesomeness." After that, towards that nature, towards that nature associated with Wholesomeness, you must direct the mind while labeling again and again, "This is Wholesomeness." Having directed the mind, you must establish mindfulness. Then Wholesomeness will be understood by you as Wholesomeness, while establishing the mind upon it. While establishing the mind upon it, you will be able to be aware Wholesomeness as Wholesomeness. Then, when you have well directed the mind towards Wholesomeness and while labeling "It is Wholesomeness," as mindfulness becomes established and established within that nature associated with Wholesomeness, there, devotees, you will get the ability to see Wholesomeness again and again, as Wholesomeness.

Acting very quickly

Then devotees, you get to identify Unwholesomeness. You get to identify Wholesomeness. Devotees, when identifying "This is Unwholesomeness" within your mental continuum and seeing "It is Unwholesomeness," and identifying "This is Wholesomeness" and seeing "Wholesomeness," from that day onwards, we don't need to tell you to abandon Unwholesomeness or to develop Wholesomeness. Because devotees, none of us like our mental continuum to be burned, scorched, soiled, or made impure.

Look now, what is the thing you devotees do most quickly the moment a garment of yours is soiled? If there is a handkerchief in your hand, if something fell on that garment, you quickly wipe that place where it fell with that handkerchief and remove that impure quality. Likewise devotees, not just garments, if you saw something as soiled, as impure, you quickly clean those things, don't you? You sweep the

dirt in your home and remove it from the home. You act very quickly to remove these soiled, impure things from garments, from utensils, and from everywhere.

Developing a determination

Then devotees, in that same way, if you devotees identified some nature as "burning, scorching, soiling, and making the mental continuum impure," you produce a desire to remove that nature from your mental continuum very quickly; you develop a determination. You begin to make an effort. You begin to inquire what should be done for that purpose.

Likewise, if your mental continuum is not burning, if it is pure, once you have seen and identified that pure nature, and also that disciplined nature, that tamed nature—along with the peaceful, favorable nature that is there, you produce a desire that "I must continue to maintain my mind in this manner," you develop a determination, you produce a strong effort.

Likewise devotees, for this much time you went searching for pleasure saying "Pleasure! Pleasure! Pleasure!" Even though you liked pleasure and went searching for pleasure in that way, here devotees, as you identify Unwholesomeness within your mental continuum and abandon Unwholesomeness, and as you identify Wholesomeness and maintain Wholesomeness, you will get to see through a awareness and wisdom produced within yourself as a direct realization that the true pleasure you searched for is received within this identifying of Wholesomeness.

I will say this with one more tiny story, devotees

I will say this with one more tiny story, devotees, to understand this nature further. We have seen a small child; if a lamp is lit

somewhere, if at some occasion a candle is lit in our house, what does this small child do? Seeing "This lamp is very beautiful," he runs to touch that lamp. But what do the parents do? Knowing and seeing that their child will be burned by that lamp, they don't let him touch that lamp. Somehow they avoid it. But, seeing a small negligence of these adults, these parents, this small child somehow reaches toward that lamp flame and touches that lamp flame. After touching it, that small child's hand begins to burn. The fingers begin to burn. As soon as it is burned, what does that child do in a second to that lamp flame he touched with desire? He abandons it. What happens to the desire that child had to touch that lamp? it is abandoned. In that same way devotees, within this Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, after identifying Unwholesomeness, after seeing that Unwholesomeness burns and scorches the mental continuum, that is why we said "it doesn't need to be said anew to abandon Unwholesomeness." We said to you "it doesn't need to be said anew to maintain Wholesomeness." That is an awareness, a wisdom that arises within you. Likewise, along with that, an effort, a determination, and a desire are produced within one's mind.

This is what it is to upholding the Dhamma, inquire into the Dhamma, and behave in the Dhamma, devotees

Therefore devotees, from here onwards, the path of Dhamma has to be practiced, has to grow, precisely through this identifying of the Unwholesomeness identified, and through the identifying of Wholesomeness. As you systematically practice the path of Dhamma forward, practice it, up until the realization of the Four Noble Truths, you will get to identify wholesome qualities and the natures of wholesome qualities through your own mental continuum. Then devotees, step by step, step by step, you identify that nature associated with Wholesomeness and you establish yourself upon it. You develop that nature associated with Wholesomeness. Step by

step, you identify Unwholesomeness and you abandon that nature associated with Unwholesomeness.

Devotees, after that, a great joy within this Dhamma will then arise in his life. Likewise, a confidence will arise in him that "we can behave in this Dhamma in this way at any occasion, at any place." Now, it is a thought that occurs to many devotees—"we don't have time; we don't have time." But devotees, at any place, at any location, at any time, look—what are you thinking? What are you contemplating? What is the nature of your mental continuum? "Is my mental continuum at this moment associated with Unwholesomeness? Is my mental continuum at this moment associated with Wholesomeness?"—is it not possible to inquire thus? This is what it is to upholding the Dhamma, inquire into the Dhamma, and behave in the Dhamma, devotees. So, we don't need a specially separated time for this.

<u>If one says or does something with a pleasant mind</u>

Devotees, from the morning until going to sleep at night, while looking towards our mental continuum, while inquiring towards the mental continuum, "Am I doing this action with a soiled mind? Am I speaking this word with a soiled mind? Am I performing this action, this word, with a mind associated with Unwholesomeness?"—is it not possible to inquire thus? Devotees, it is possible.

Do you remember the first and second verses that come in the Yamaka Vagga of the Dhammapada?

Manōpubbaṅgamā dhammā - manōsēṭṭhā manōmayā
Manasā cē paduṭṭhēna - bhāsati vā karōti vā
Tatō naṃ dukkhamanvēti - cakkaṃ'va vahatō padaṃ

The mental factors (such as feeling) have the mind as their precursor. They have the mind as their chief. They are born of the mind itself. If one speaks (the fourfold verbal misconduct such as false speech) or does (the threefold bodily misconduct such as killing) with a soiled mind, because of that, suffering follows him. Like the wheel of the cart that follows the ox.

Manōpubbaṅgamā dhammā - manōsēṭṭhā manōmayā
Manasā cē pasannēna - bhāsati vā karōti vā
Tatō naṃ sukhamanvēti - chāyā'va anapāyinī

The mental factors (such as feeling) have the mind as their precursor. They have the mind as their chief. They are born of the mind itself. If one says or does something with a pleasant mind, because of that, pleasure follows him. Like the shadow that follows without abandoning oneself.

Manōpubbaṅgamā dhammā manōsēṭṭhā manōmayā manasācē paduṭṭhēna bhāsati vā karōti vā—"Are you doing something with that soiled mind? Are you saying something?"—There, you can search, devotees. Can you not see, devotees, that "Are you saying or doing something with such a soiled mind? That exists for my disadvantage, for suffering"?

Likewise, **Manōpubbaṅgamā dhammā manōsēṭṭhā manōmayā manasā cē pasannēna bhāsati vā karōti vā**—"Am I performing this thing said, this thing done, with a mind associated with Wholesomeness? With a pure mind? With a disciplined mind? With a tamed mind?"—you can think and contemplate well, can't you devotees? If you say or do things with your mind being pure, there, The Lord Buddha mentions in the Dhamma that "it exists for one's own pleasure."

<u>Look at the entire instruction of all the Exalted Fully Enlightened Buddhas</u>

Therefore devotees, look—within the listening to the Dhamma, what you must do first, then, is to identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness. So, having met the Good spiritual friend, when you listen to the Dhamma, within the listening to the Dhamma, the Good spiritual friends show you "identify Wholesomeness in this way; identify Unwholesomeness in this way." Devotees, look at the entire instruction of all the Exalted Fully Enlightened Buddhas:

Sabbapāpassa akaraṇaṃ - kusalassa upasampadā
Sacittapariyōdapanaṃ - ētaṃ buddhānusāsanaṃ

Not doing all unwholesome actions (such as killing), and the production of all mundane and supramundane wholesome states (from the point of leaving the home and ordaining until reaching the fruit of Arahantship), and the development of the produced Wholesomeness, and the purification of one's own mind (from the five hindrances)—all this is the instruction (advice) of all Buddhas.

Sabbapāpassa akaraṇaṃ, kusalassa upasampadā, sacittapariyōdapanaṃ, ētaṃ buddhānusāsanaṃ—"Not doing all unwholesome things, producing wholesome things, and taming the mind"—this is said to be the instruction of all The Lord Buddhas.

<u>The starting step is identifying Unwholesomeness in this way</u>

Then, if we are to not do unwholesome things, we must identify Unwholesomeness. If so, if we are to produce wholesome things, we must identify Wholesomeness. Within this identifying of Unwholesomeness and Wholesomeness, within the abandoning of Unwholesomeness, and within the producing of Wholesomeness, our mental continuum begins to be tamed. As the mind becomes tamed and tamed, devotees, our mind begins to grow in this Dhamma path very quickly and speedily up to the point of realizing the Four Noble

Truths. So, its beginning, the starting step, is identifying Unwholesomeness in this way. Identifying Wholesomeness in this way.

One directs the mind again and again towards the unwholesome nature, while labeling "This is Unwholesomeness"

- Then devotees, if you are to identify Unwholesomeness, to identify Wholesomeness, what is it you have to do? You must look towards your own mind.

- Now, we asked at the very beginning: "Where is this Unwholesomeness born? Where is this Wholesomeness born?" Then, the answer that must be given is: "Wholesomeness is born within one's own mind. Unwholesomeness is born within one's own mind."

- Then devotees, if you are to identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, it becomes necessary for you to look towards your own mind with the intention of identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness.

- There, when looking towards your own mind with the intention of identifying Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, devotees, if your mental continuum is burning, if it is scorching, and likewise if it is soiled, if it is impure, if it is undisciplined, if it is not tamed—along with that nature, what do we do? We identify and mark "This is Unwholesomeness."

- Having thus identified and marked it; while looking towards that nature again and again, one directs the mind again and again towards that nature. One labels "This is Unwholesomeness."

- Having directed the mind while thus labeling, you establish mindfulness well in that nature associated with Unwholesomeness.

- Then, along with the way that Unwholesomeness arose, you can see it with that growing awareness and wisdom. We will preach those in future sermons.

One inclines the mind again and again towards the wholesome nature, while reflecting "This is Wholesomeness"

- Devotees, if your mental continuum is not burning, if it is not scorching, and likewise if it is not soiled, if it is pure, if it is disciplined, if it is tamed—along with that nature, what do we do? We identify and mark "This is Wholesomeness."

- Having thus identified and marked it; while looking towards that nature again and again, one directs the mind again and again towards that nature. One labels "This is Wholesomeness."

- Having directed the mind while thus labeling, you establish mindfulness well in that nature associated with Wholesomeness.

- Then, along with the way that Wholesomeness arose, you can see it with that growing awareness and wisdom. We will preach those in future sermons.

One becomes a person traveling on the path to Nibbāna

Then you can see Unwholesomeness, and you can see Wholesomeness. Then devotees, you must perform this exercise frequently and again and again. Within that performance, you will be able to identify

Unwholesomeness and identify Wholesomeness. As you identify Unwholesomeness in this way, you become someone who has started to abandon Unwholesomeness. In the place where you identified Wholesomeness, you become someone who tries to maintain Wholesomeness.

So, we told you in the previous sermon, if you can daily, every moment that passes, every minute, every hour, you must become someone who practices this path to Nibbāna. In this way, every moment you look at your mental continuum, every moment you identify Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, you transform into the state of someone practicing the path to Nibbāna within the path to Nibbāna. So therefore devotees, you listened well to this sermon; having listened and having taken this mentioned manner well to heart and having contemplated, it is necessary to be someone who constantly looks towards your own side, towards your own mind, in the manner said within this Dhamma.

As you look more and more towards your own side, as you look more and more towards your own mind, there, you can identify the Dhamma. You can see the Dhamma. You become someone who has well corrected the shortcomings within the Dhamma. Likewise, you become a person traveling on the path to Nibbāna. So therefore, you who listened to this sermon, look towards your own mind in that way. Look towards your own mind and mark Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness. Having thus marked Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness, direct the mind towards that Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness and establish mindfulness.

May there be the refuge of the Triple Gem to all these devotees!

So therefore devotees, we mention that matter to you in this way within this sermon and hope to stop, conclude, and finish this sermon here. In the next sermon devotees, then what we have—now we have

been performing a series of sermons up to this point. Prior merit must exist. Good spiritual friends must be found by having that prior merit as a condition. After that, the Dhamma must be heard from the Good spiritual friend. Within the listening to the Dhamma, by now, we have brought the sermon of the series to the point that Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness must be identified. After that devotees, having the identifying of Wholesomeness and Unwholesomeness as a condition, we hope to perform that sermon for you on the next day through the next topic that "you must identify the roots of Wholesomeness and the roots of Unwholesomeness."

So, may this merit of having heard this Dhamma be a cause for all these devotees for the very realization of the Four Noble Truths, for the very cooling of the deathless Great Nibbāna! May you be fortunate! May it be an auspicious perfection itself! —Wishing thus, I finish the sermon.

May there be the refuge of the Triple Gem to all these devotees!

Ēkapuggalassa bhikkhave pātubhāvā mahatō cakkhussa pātubhāvō hōti, mahatō ālōkassa pātubhāvō hōti, mahatō obhāsassa pātubhāvō hōti, channaṃ anuttariyānaṃ pātubhāvō hōti, catunnaṃ paṭisambhidānaṃ sacchikiriyā hōti, anēkadhātupaṭivēdhō hōti, nānādhātupaṭivēdhō hōti, vijjāvimuttiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, sōtāpattiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, sakadāgāmiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, anāgāmiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, arahattaphalasacchikiriyā hōti. Katamassa ēkapuggalassa: Tathāgatassa arahatō sammāsambuddhassa. Imassa khō bhikkhave ēkapuggalassa pātubhāvā mahatō cakkhussa pātubhāvō hōti, mahatō ālōkassa pātubhāvō hōti, mahatō obhāsassa pātubhāvō hōti, channaṃ anuttariyānaṃ pātubhāvō hōti, catunnaṃ paṭisambhidānaṃ sacchikiriyā hōti, anēka dhātupaṭivēdhō hōti, nānādhātupaṭivēdhō hōti, vijjāvimuttiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, sōtāpattiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, sakadāgāmiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, anāgāmiphalasacchikiriyā hōti, arahattaphalasacchikiriyā hōtīti.

"Monks, with the appearance of one person, there is the appearance of a great eye (of wisdom), the appearance of a great light, the appearance of a great radiance. There is the appearance of the six unsurpassed things; the realization of the four analytical knowledges; the penetration of many elements; the penetration of various elements; the realization of the fruit of knowledge and liberation; the realization of the fruit of Stream-entry; the realization of the fruit of Once-returning; the realization of the fruit of non-returning; and the realization of the fruit of Arahantship.

Of which one person? Of the Tathāgata, the Arahant, the Sammāsambuddha (the Fully Enlightened One). Monks, it is with the appearance of this one person that there is the appearance of a great eye, a great light, and a great radiance... the realization of the fruit of Stream-entry, Once-returning, Non-returning, and Arahantship."

(Aṅguttara Nikāya, Ekaka Nipāta, Ekapuggala Vagga)